

Frequently asked questions on course project requirements

1. Must it be government API, can it be APIs from non-official government source?

The Lab manual allows for non-government sources of data. Publicly available APIs are preferable. If you use crawler technologies (e.g. Scrapy, webscraping) to query the information, you must be careful about the **legality**. Some websites **PROHIBIT** using crawlers to access their private data. Better check with the website owner for their approval.

2. Lab 3 code must be in what language?

Any language is acceptable.

3. Can one use ChatGPT to generate code?

Any use of AI assistance for code generation or otherwise must be explicitly disclosed in line with NTU's guidelines on academic integrity. While we do not fully forbid the use of these tools (with proper disclosure), the project is at risk of significant penalisation if students cannot explain its internal technical details to the TA.

4. Can I use "low-code" tools to generate parts of my application?

You can use low-code tools to generate some components of your application (such as the front-end). You should clearly disclose which parts of your application used these tools to your TA during any submission and (final) presentation where the generated work is used. Your report should still document any generated components of your system using use-case and class diagrams, and you should be prepared to explain to the TA how the low-code generation process was carried out. The TA should take into account which aspects of the project were generated by low-code tools when assessing the overall complexity of the implementation effort – there should be hand-coded components of the system involving non-trivial work in order to attract good marks.

5. For Lab 5 presentation, what other factors beside those mentioned in lab manual will impact grading?

The applications will be judged by the innovative use of data and the overall quality of the presentation. Note that the deliverables marked during labs 2,3,4 also contribute to the project's overall grade.

6. Do we need to fill in every detail in the templated SRS, or just the 4 deliverables:

The work from previous labs should be re-organized into SRS, referencing the provided template. The analysis models can be included in Appendix B. Students can modify the template but the final SRS should at least include:

- Documentation of functional and non-functional requirements
- Data dictionary
- Initial Use Case Model, consisting of Use Case diagram and Use Case descriptions
- UI Mockups

7. Are there any restriction on selecting the project's topic:

There are no restrictions.

8. Are there any restrictions on the selection and use of APIs, and must the APIs specified in the documentation be used :

There are no restrictions, although bear in mind the lab guidance on the use of weather APIs.

9. Can the lab deliverables be modified after submission:

The deliverable for each lab (1,2,3,4) is marked based on the current state of the project at the point of submission (the start of the subsequent lab, and note that it's ok if the design of the system changes between labs). At this point, the relevant deliverable is "locked in" and can no longer be changed for the purpose of that lab's marks. The TA should give feedback on the submission during the relevant lab, but may choose not to release marks at this stage. The final set of deliverables for lab 5 includes finalised and updated versions of the previous labs' deliverables to reflect the final system design, and these can be modified until the Sunday at the end of the presentation week 2359hrs.

10. How will the grading be done:

Check the lab manual

11. Peer Review duration, is it compulsory?

Peer Review/Evaluation for your course projects happens in April or November depending on the term. It is a mandatory and confidential individual task. Please provide justifications if you give review score 1 or 2.

12. Who to seek help for if there's a disagreement within the team or team member not doing his/her role?

Email the Lab Executive first, if it still can't be resolved, the TA should be notified. Every student is expected to contribute fairly and equally to each lab and to fully understand the requirements of each lab. It is not acceptable for a student to contribute less to one lab and compensate by contributing more to another. A declaration of contribution form will be made and each submission must clearly indicate the contributions of each team member. Final marks may be adjusted based on both the overall team score and individual contributions.

13. Is the repository still accessible after final submission deadline?

Each team is responsible for maintaining their own backups. Access to the repository will not be granted after the final deliverables deadline, regardless of whether it is for backup purposes or review.

14. Can the team be formed by students themselves?

All teams are arranged and distributed by the TA and decision is final. Any attempt to switch teams is strongly discouraged. Students are expected to commit to their assigned teams for the entire duration of the project. Changing teams without a valid reason, and without prior approval from the TA/Lab Supervisor, will result in serious academic consequences. Consistent team membership is essential to ensure fairness, accountability, and equal participation.